criteria that you would expect for our systems, not necessarily the way they went about doing it. And it was ameliorated a little bit by the feedback coming back from the Indians. And nobody is required to tell us the truth. But it was ameliorated a little bit by their responses that laid out for instance this business about establishing the National Security Council and then subsequently I think we had some evidence that suggested that not all the leadership knew what was going on, and therefore, were not able to deal with it.'

The CIA had placed at least one intelligence analyst at Langley to specifically monitor India's nuclear programme and after the furor, Jeremiah proposed scrubbing the American intelligence community with a wire brush and polishing it up to make sure it worked right; that everyone understood their responsibilities, that somebody was in charge of certain areas and that they had a reporting mechanism and authority.

Jeremiah was also asked whether the US intelligence community lacked assets and understanding about India, Indian cultures and how Indians react to certain problems or behave in certain ways. More specifically, he was asked that if there were no people in the CIA who understood India, would he get people like that? Jeremiah replied that he had recommended acquiring sources that might be in a better place to predict the future.

A press reporter commented to Jeremiah that American's Human Intelligence (HUMINT) capability, as far as India was concerned, was limited. He said: 'There was comment after this episode that it underscored the idea that there simply were no solid sources inside India, and that pointed to a larger weakness in the human intelligence community.'